POSTULATE 1

5

- The reference η encodes your **prior** structural knowledge about the space before any energy constraint is imposed

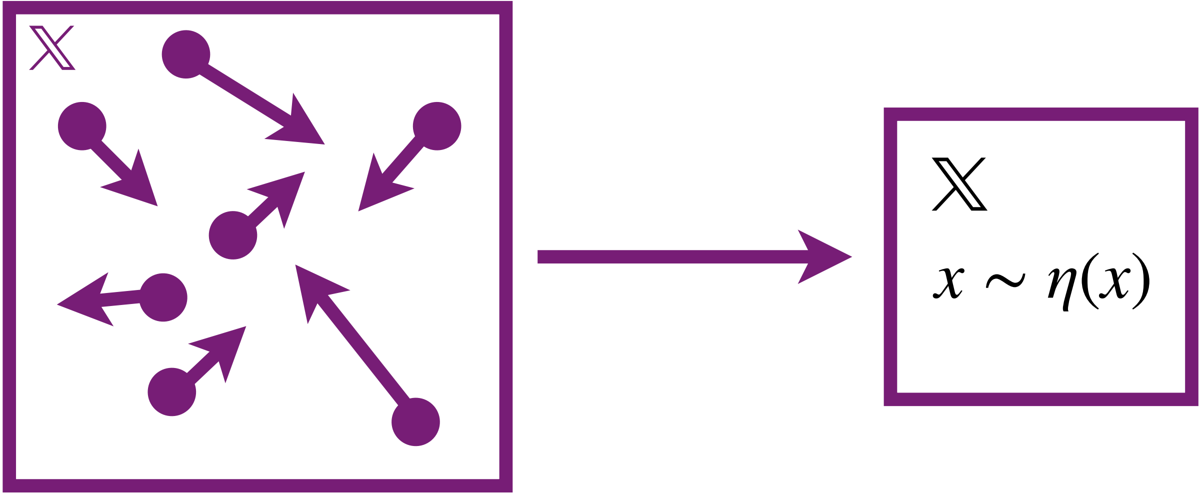
- **Postulate 1:** There exists a **default measure** η over states $x \in \mathbb{X}$ representing complete ignorance, i.e the distribution you would assign if you knew nothing about the system.

- **Example:** in a continuous system η is proportional to phase space volume (Lebesgue measure on positions and momenta)

- **Example:** in a discrete system η can be the counting measure

- When the reference is the uniform measure, all states are equally probable

- **Example:** the state of your molecule before a reaction occurs



$\mathbb{X}$
$\mathbb{X}$
$x \sim \eta(x)$

POSTULATE 1

- **Postulate 1:** There exists a **default measure** η over states $x \in \mathbb{X}$ representing complete ignorance, i.e the distribution you would assign if you knew nothing about the system.
    - The reference η encodes your **prior** structural knowledge about the space before any energy constraint is imposed
    - When the reference is the uniform measure, all states are equally probable
    - **Example:** in a continuous system η is proportional to phase space volume (Lebesgue measure on positions and momenta)
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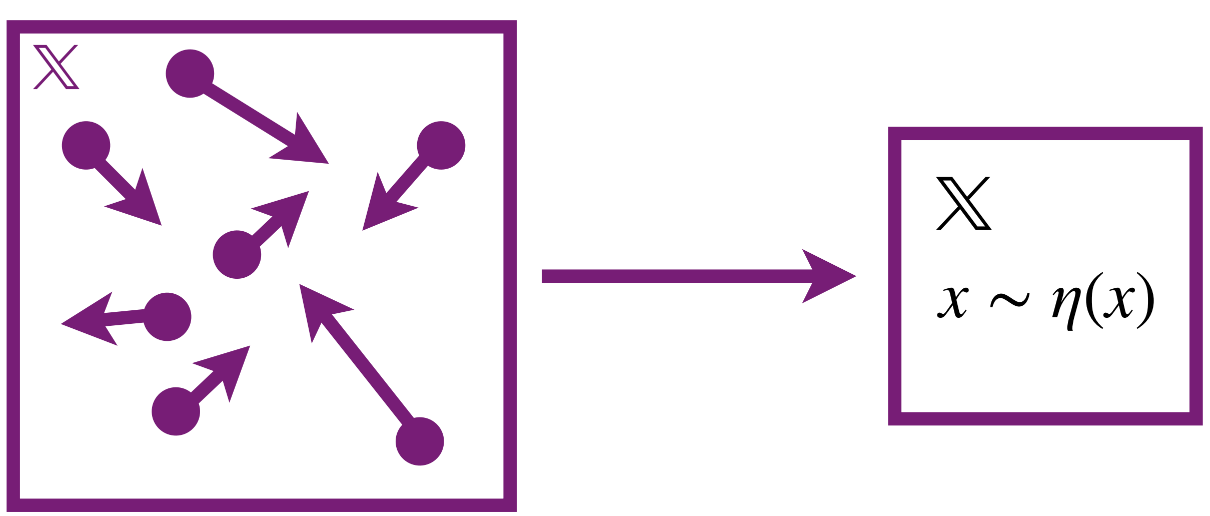

POSTULATE 2